Glimpses of India

Master Revision: First Flight Chapter 5

A Cinematic Journey Through India's Cultural & Geographical Diversity

Destinations Covered:

1. **A Baker from Goa** (by Lucio Rodrigues) – Portuguese Heritage & Traditions
2. **Coorg** (by Lokesh Abrol) – Coffee, Rainforests & Valour
3. **Tea from Assam** (by Arup Kumar Datta) – Tea Gardens & Ancient Legends

Gemini Notebook

A Baker from Goa: The Portuguese Legacy

"Those eaters of loaves might have vanished, but the makers are still there."

The Nostalgic Past

Elders nostalgically reminisce about the good old Portuguese days and their famous loaves of bread.

The Artisans

The traditional bakers are still known as pader. We still have amongst us the mixers, moulders, and those who bake.

The Equipment & Sound

Age-old furnaces with fire not yet extinguished. Heralded by the thud and jingle of the traditional bamboo staff.

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The Daily Routine of the Pader

A friend, companion, and guide to the children of Goa.

Two Visits a Day

Morning: Sets out on his selling round with a musical 'jhang, jhang' entry (one hand supports the basket, the other bangs the bamboo).

Evening: Returns after emptying his huge basket.

For the Elders

Traditional loaves of bread, bought by the maid-servant (Paskine or Bastine).

For the Children

Sweet bread-bangles. Kids didn't even brush their teeth! ("The tiger never brushed his teeth. Hot tea could wash… everything.")

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The Cultural Importance of Goan Bread

A village without a baker's furnace loses its charm.

Marriage Gifts

Meaningless without the sweet bread known as *bol*.

Parties & Feasts

Lose their charm without traditional bread.

Daughter's Engagement

The lady of the house must prepare sandwiches.

Christmas & Festivals

Cakes and *bolinhas* are an absolute must.

Core Insight: The presence of the baker's furnace in the village is absolutely essential for every cultural milestone.

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The Identity of the Pader

Dress, accounts, and a profitable profession.

The Traditional Dress

Anatomy of a Baker

Past: The *kabai* — a peculiar single-piece long frock reaching down to the knees.

Present: Shirt and trousers shorter than full-length but longer than half pants.

(Wearing half-pants today still invites the comment: "dressed like a pader!")

Business & Prosperity

Billing:

Monthly accounts recorded on a wall in pencil; collected at month-end.

Prosperity:

Baking was highly profitable; families never starved. They had a plump physique (an open testimony to prosperity). Anyone with a "jackfruit-like physical appearance" is compared to a baker.

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Super Revision: A Baker from Goa

Board Exam Quick-Recall Facts

Author:
Lucio Rodrigues

Theme:
Nostalgia for old Portuguese days & traditional bread.

Key Name:
Traditional baker is called a Pader.

Arrival:
Announced by the thud and jingle of a bamboo staff.

Childhood memory:
Longing for sweet bread-bangles.

Cultural must-haves:
Bol (marriages), Sandwiches (engagements), Cakes/Bolinhas (Christmas).

Dress: Kabai (single-piece long frock).

Status:
Profitable profession; prosperous, plump, jackfruit-like physique.

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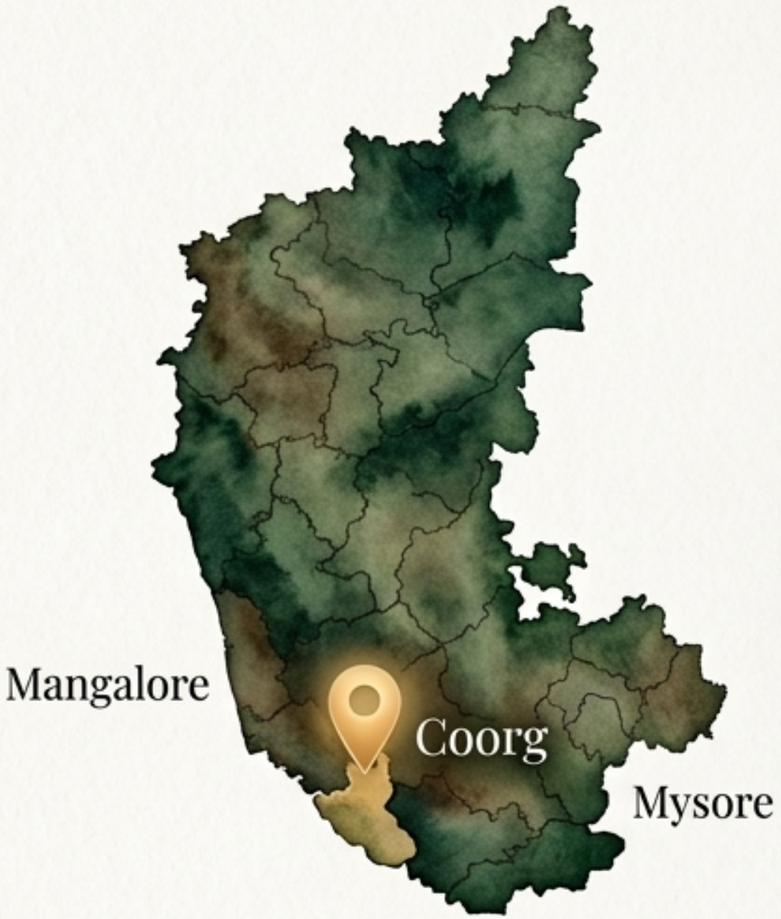
Coorg: The Coffee Country

"A piece of heaven that must have drifted from the kingdom of god."



Location & Landscape

- Also known as Kodagu, the smallest district of Karnataka.
- Located midway between Mysore and Mangalore.
- Home to evergreen rainforests (covering 30% of the district), spices, and coffee plantations.

Climate & Weather

- **Monsoons**: Pours heavily, keeping many visitors away.
- **Season of Joy**: September to March. Perfect weather with showers.
- **Atmosphere**: The air breathes of invigorating coffee.

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The Fiercely Independent Kodavus

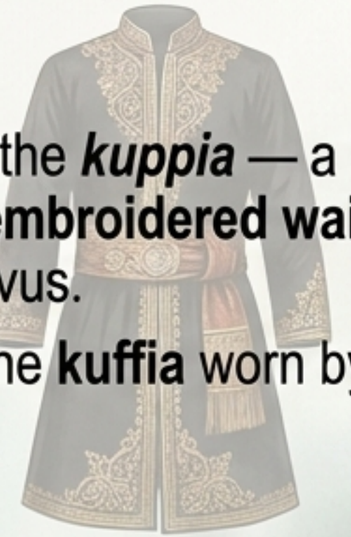
A proud race of martial men and beautiful women.

Greek Descent Theory

A part of Alexander's army moved south along the **coast**, settled here when return became impractical, and married locals.

Evident in **martial traditions**, marriage, and religious rites.

Arab Descent Theory



Supported by the ***kuppia*** — a **long, black coat** with an **embroidered waist-belt** worn by Kodavus.

It resembles the **kuffia** worn by Arabs and Kurds.

Culture & Bravery: Famous for hospitality and tales of valour. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army. General Cariappa (first Army Chief) was a Coorgi.
Unique Privilege: The only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a license.

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High-Energy Adventure & Wild Creatures

Where the most laidback individuals become converts to adventure.

The River Kaveri Ecosystem

Obtains its water from Coorg's hills and forests.

Mahaseer (large freshwater fish) abound in these waters.

Diving kingfishers, macaques, Malabar squirrels, slender loris, and wild elephants bathed by mahouts.

High-Energy Adventure Sports

Water Sports: River rafting and canoeing.

Rope & Rock: Rappelling and rock climbing.

Trails: Mountain biking and numerous walking trails (a favourite with trekkers).

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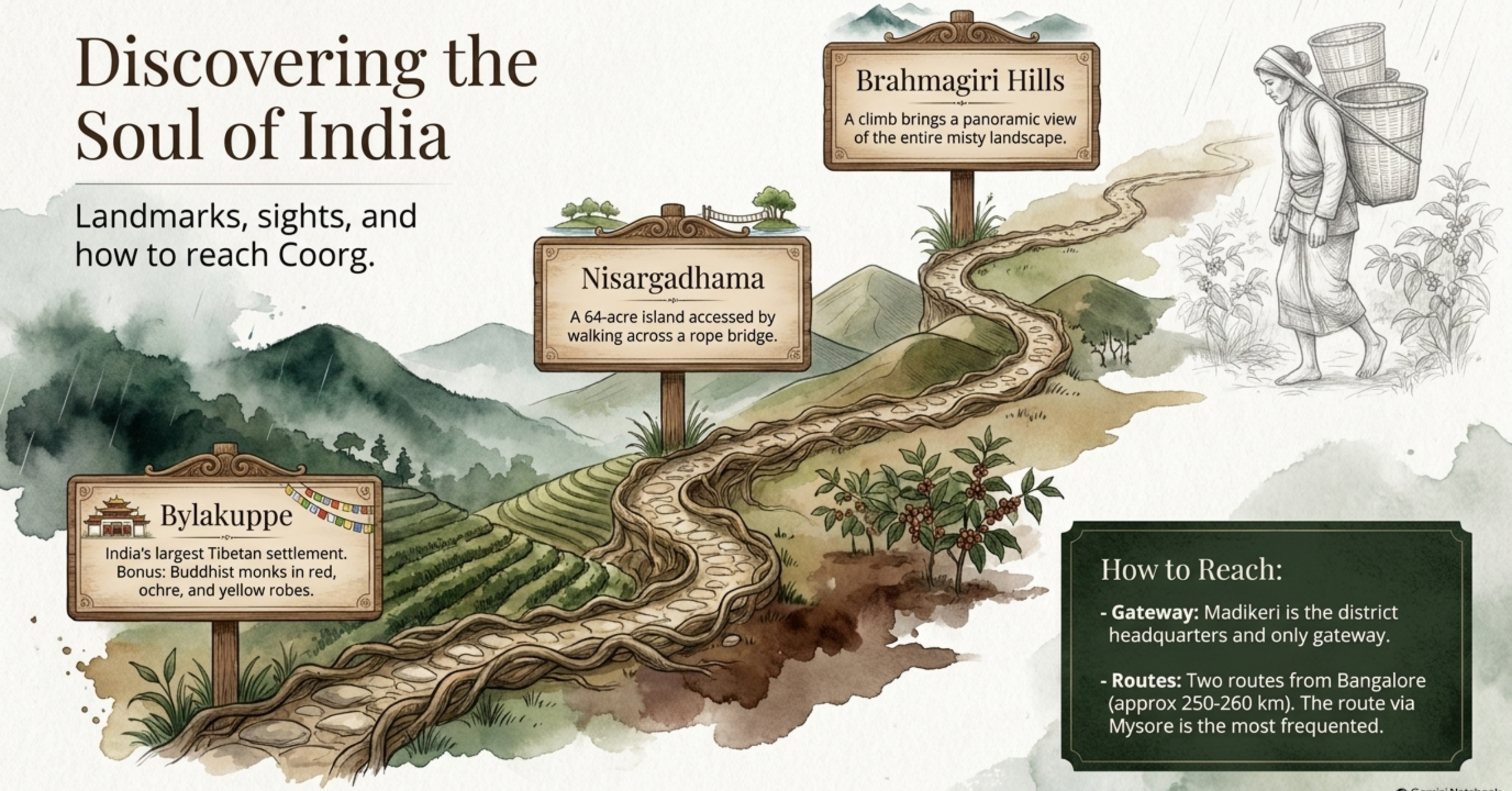
Discovering the Soul of India

Landmarks, sights, and how to reach Coorg.



How to Reach:

- **Gateway:** Madikeri is the district headquarters and only gateway.
- **Routes:** Two routes from Bangalore (approx 250-260 km). The route via Mysore is the most frequented.

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Tea from Assam: A Journey into Greenery

"Assam has the largest concentration of plantations in the world."

The Characters & Setting

- Rajvir & Pranjol: Classmates in Delhi.
- Pranjol's father manages the Dhekiabari tea-garden in Upper Assam.
- Rajvir is invited for the summer vacation.

The Journey Begins

- A vendor calls out "Chai-garam... garam-chai".
- Fun Fact: Over 80 crore cups of tea are drunk every day throughout the world.
- The View: Rajvir is amazed by the magnificent view stretching as far as the eye could see.

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Myths, Legends, and the History of Tea

"No one really knows who discovered tea but there are many legends."

Two Famous Legends

The Chinese Legend:
A Chinese emperor always boiled water. Twigs burning under the pot dropped leaves into the water, giving it a delicious flavour.

The Indian Legend:
Bodhidharma, an ancient Buddhist ascetic, cut off his sleepy eyelids during meditation. Ten tea plants grew from them, whose leaves banished sleep.

Historical Facts

2700 B.C.
First drunk in China
(Words like chai and chini are Chinese).

16th Century
Came to Europe, where it was drunk more as a medicine than as a beverage.

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Inside Dhekiabari Tea Estate

The business of plucking the perfect leaf.

The Estate Landscape:
Gravel roads bordered by neatly pruned tea bushes, all cut to the exact same height.

The Tea Pluckers:
Groups of workers wearing plastic aprons with bamboo baskets on their backs, busily plucking leaves like "doll-like figures."

The Sprouting Period:
Known as the Second-Flush. Lasts from May to July and yields the best tea.

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High-Scoring Board Vocabulary

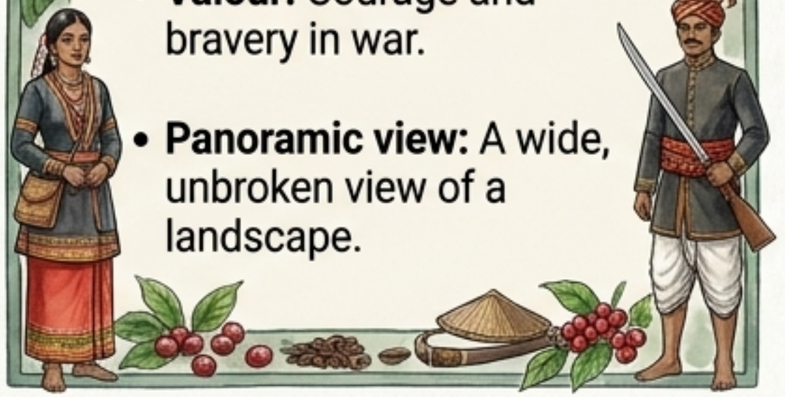
Use these exact NCERT words to elevate your exam answers.

Goa Vocabulary

- **Reminiscing nostalgically:** Thinking fondly of the past.
- **Heralding:** Announcing an arrival.
- **Rebuke:** An expression of disapproval / a mild scolding.
- **Plump physique:** Pleasantly fat body (sign of prosperity).

Coorg Vocabulary

- **Martial:** Having to do with war.
- **Canopies:** Roof-like coverings that form shelters.
- **Valour:** Courage and bravery in war.
- **Panoramic view:** A wide, unbroken view of a landscape.



Assam Vocabulary

- **Ardent:** Enthusiastic or passionate.
- **Billowing:** Smoke moving or flowing outwards.
- **Ascetic:** A person who practices severe self-discipline.
- **Pruned:** Trimmed bushes to maintain the same height.

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Master Chapter Revision Matrix

The Ultimate Glimpses of India Cheat Sheet

Feature	A Baker from Goa	Coorg	Tea from Assam
Author	Lucio Rodrigues	Lokesh Abrol	Arup Kumar Datta
Core Theme	Portuguese heritage & the role of the Pader.	Martial race, coffee, rainforests & adventure.	The vast tea gardens of Assam & ancient legends.
Key Terms	Pader, Kabai, Bol, Bolinhas	Kodavus, Kuppia, Mahaseer, Brahmagiri	Bodhidharma, Second-flush, Dhekiabari
Origin/History	Portuguese influence in Goa.	Greek (Alexander) or Arab descent.	Chinese (2700 B.C.) and Indian legends.
Economy/Crop	Baking (highly profitable).	Coffee & Spices.	Tea Plantations.
Key Insight	The baker is essential for every Goan cultural event.	Coorgis are famously hospitable & brave.	Assam has the largest concentration of tea plantations in the world.

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